

Sick Leave Policy

Northgate Group — HR Policy | Version 3.1 | Effective 1 January 2026 | Owner: People Operations

1. Purpose and Scope

This Sick Leave Policy explains the paid sick leave allowance available to employees of Northgate Group, the procedure for reporting an absence due to illness, when a medical certificate is required, and how extended or repeated absences are managed. It applies to all permanent employees from their first day of employment, including those serving a probation period.

2. Sick Leave Allowance

Employees are entitled to 10 paid sick leave days per calendar year. The allowance is not pro-rated for joiners and does not carry over into the following year. Unused sick leave is never paid out and has no cash value.

Sick leave is counted in working days. A partial day of absence for a medical appointment is not deducted from the allowance provided the appointment is recorded with the line manager and the employee works the balance of the day.

- Paid sick leave allowance: 10 working days per calendar year.
- The allowance resets on 1 January and does not carry over.
- Absence beyond 10 days in a year is unpaid unless certified and approved as extended sickness.
- Sick leave is separate from the 20-day annual leave entitlement.

3. Reporting Procedure

An employee who is unable to attend work because of illness must notify their line manager directly before 09:30 on the first day of absence, by telephone or instant message. A voicemail alone is not sufficient notification. The employee must also raise a Leave Request in the employee portal, entering the first and expected last day of absence, so that the absence is recorded against the correct allowance.

If the absence continues beyond the expected end date, the employee must inform the line manager again and add a comment to the existing request rather than raising a second one. Failure to report an absence in line with this procedure may result in the absence being recorded as unauthorised and unpaid.

4. Medical Certificate Requirements

A medical certificate from a licensed practitioner is required for any absence of three or more consecutive working days. The certificate must be submitted to People Operations within two working days of returning to work, or sooner where the absence is ongoing.

A certificate may also be requested for shorter absences where there is a pattern of repeated single-day absence, or where an absence falls immediately before or after a weekend, public holiday or period of approved annual leave. Certificates are held confidentially by People Operations and are not shared with the line manager.

5. Extended Sickness Absence

Absence continuing beyond 10 working days is classified as extended sickness. People Operations will contact the employee to agree a review schedule, confirm the expected return date and discuss any workplace adjustments needed on return. Extended sickness absence is unpaid beyond the annual allowance unless the employee is covered by a separate insured scheme.

A return-to-work conversation with the line manager is required after any absence of five or more consecutive working days. The conversation is supportive rather than disciplinary and is intended to confirm fitness to return and agree any phased return.

6. Sickness During Annual Leave

An employee who falls ill during a period of approved annual leave may request that the affected days be reclassified as sick leave, provided the illness is supported by a medical certificate covering those dates and People Operations is notified during the leave period rather than afterwards. Reclassified days are returned to the annual leave balance.

7. Confidentiality

Medical information provided in support of a sick leave absence is treated as confidential personal data. It is stored by People Operations with restricted access, is not visible in the ticket record seen by line managers or IT administrators, and is retained only for as long as is required by law.